

Katherine Root

Mountain View, CA | (908) 392-1284 | keroot@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/katherineroot | katherineroot.com

Design Leader and Staff Product Designer with 14+ years of experience building design teams, setting long-term product strategy, and launching complex software across web and mobile. Proven track record of scaling consumer apps and regulated health tools—from managing multi-level design teams to guiding new AI features from idea to launch. Skilled at partnering with executive, clinical, and engineering leaders to align design with business goals, simplify complex workflows, and build high-quality user experiences.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Leadership & Operations: Hiring & Team Management, Mentorship, Performance Reviews, Resource Planning, Design Operations, Executive Alignment (C-Suite, Product, Engineering)

Execution & Architecture: End-to-End Product Design, Multi-Platform Systems, Interaction Design, Workflow Simplification, Rapid Prototyping, Craft Elevation, WCAG Accessibility (AA/AAA)

Strategy & Governance: New Product Innovation, Enterprise Governance, Hardware/Software Ecosystems, Multi-Year Roadmaps, Regulatory Compliance and Risk Mitigation

Design & Collaboration: Figma, ProtoPie, Jitter, Adobe Creative Suite, Sketch, Jira, Shortcut, Slack

AI & Technical Workflows: Claude Code, Claude Design, Lovable, Vercel, Supabase, Conversational UX, Prompt Engineering, AI Content Workflows, Native iOS, Native Android, Responsive Web

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of Design Manta Cares | San Francisco, CA | May 2025 – Jul 2026

Brought on to lead the end-to-end product design and AI features for an oncology healthcare platform, managing product strategy, patient research, and cross-functional work with clinical leaders.

- Owned the full end-to-end design process for native iOS and Android apps—creating user flows, wireframes, high-fidelity UI, and interactive prototypes; designs drove 792 first-time downloads in the first 6 months live.
- Led design and product rollout for HopeAI, an in-app conversational AI guide. Grew weekly active users ~5x and reached 1,408 distinct patients in 5 months, with roughly half of conversations continuing past a single exchange.
- Partnered with clinicians, healthcare providers, and pharma stakeholders to translate complex, safety-critical requirements into experiences that were clear, accurate, and high-trust.
- Reduced feature-set complexity to remove noise from the core experience, sustaining an onboarding conversion rate of 88%–96%.
- Built automated AI content workflows using custom Claude agents to structure dense clinical documentation into clear, scannable UI components, accelerating production while maintaining medical compliance.
- Defined and shipped an updated brand identity, extending it from digital interfaces into print and physical patient materials for a cohesive online-to-offline experience in clinical communities.

Director of Design Mighty Networks | Remote | Jul 2020 – May 2025

Managed a team of 11 designers, oversaw company-wide design operations, and partnered with C-suite executives to scale a global SaaS platform across mobile and web.

- Hired, managed, and mentored a team of 11 designers (up to 8 direct reports concurrently) across associate through lead levels, establishing hiring standards, promotion tracks, and org stability through major transitions.
- Architected custom career-development frameworks, bi-weekly 1:1 structures, annual skill matrix evaluations, and design reviews, driving high retention and operational rigor across the department.
- Partnered directly with C-suite executives to establish long-term product vision, defined development lifecycles, and aligned design strategy with enterprise growth metrics.
- Architected and governed a multi-platform design system across native iOS, Android, and web, standardizing component libraries with dynamic multi-state logic that enabled distributed teams to ship consistent UI at scale.
- Served as lead individual contributor on critical company initiatives, delivering high-fidelity UI, system flows, and interactive prototypes for flagship platform overhauls, including "Spaces" and "Membership Plans."
- Directed native iOS and Android experience strategies, overseeing complex app store release and deployment pipelines for white-label products and enterprise business clients.
- Founded company-wide collaborative programs, including monthly "Make Mighty Cool" sessions and rapid AI prototyping initiatives, resulting in productizing 15+ features and embedding user-centered design methodologies across engineering, marketing, customer success, and more.
- Instilled human-centered design methods across all product work and evangelized design's strategic role company-wide.

Senior Product Designer Mighty Networks | Palo Alto, CA | Dec 2018 – Jul 2020

Architected core engagement frameworks, leading a complete event management system overhaul (integrating real-time video/Zoom) and multi-channel notification architecture across web and mobile ecosystems.

Product Designer Mighty Networks | Palo Alto, CA | Oct 2015 – Dec 2018

Designed and directed the creation of the initial native Android application; designed end-to-end digital transaction systems, structured learning module workflows, and administrative customization portals.

EARLY CAREER PRODUCT DESIGN ROLES

Product Designer | Simply Hired | Sunnyvale, CA | Feb 2014 – Oct 2015

Product Design Consultant | CircleBlack | Remote | Dec 2013 – Feb 2014

Lead Interaction Designer | Copper | San Mateo, CA | May 2013 – Dec 2013

Interaction Designer | Launch Design | Los Altos, CA | Aug 2012 – May 2013

EDUCATION

University of Washington

Seattle, WA | 2008 - 2012 | BS Informatics, HCI Concentration, Interaction Design Minor